MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026- Fourth SEMESTER

Q.P.25901528 - Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSESWK202 - Human Resource Management & Development

Part A Very Short Answer- Answer all questions Each question carries 1 marks

1. Match the term "Welfare Officer" with the early stage of HRM. -[K] / [CO1] 1 marks

Welfare Officer → Welfare Stage (Labour Welfare Stage) of HRM
This stage focused on employee well-being, working conditions, and basic welfare services.

2. Outline one method of assessing candidates. - [U] / [CO2] 1 marks

Interview – used to evaluate skills, personality, and suitability.

3. What is autonomy in organisational climate? - [K] / [CO3] 1 marks

It refers to the **degree of freedom and independence** given to employees in decision-making and work.

4. State any two purposes of HRD for management.- [U] / [CO4] 1 marks

Improve **employee performance and productivity**
Develop **leadership and managerial skills**

5. State one purpose of employee assistance programs. - [U] / [CO5] 1 marks

To provide **counselling and support** for employees facing personal or work-related problems

6. Relate HR practices to employee performance. - [K] / [CO6- 1 marks

Effective HR practices like training, appraisal, and motivation **enhance employee efficiency, satisfaction, and productivity**.

7. Define HRP strategy . -[K] / [CO1-1 marks

Human Resource Planning strategy is the **process of forecasting and planning workforce needs** to achieve organizational goals.

8. Describe the importance of quantitative planning. - [U] / [CO2] 1 marks

Helps in **accurate forecasting of manpower needs** using data and statistical techniques.

9. Identify one tool used in career planning. - [U] / [CO3] 1 marks

One tool used in career planning: Performance appraisal

10. Identify one factor that improves workplace harmony. - [U] / [CO4] 1 marks

One factor improving workplace harmony: Effective communication

Part B Short Answer Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 3 marks

11. Illustrate how appraisal supports employee development. -[A] / [CO5]- 3 marks

- Identifies **strengths and weaknesses** for improvement.
- Helps in **training and development planning**.
- Provides **feedback and motivation** for career growth.

12. Interpret how proper Selection reduces employee turnover. -[A] / [CO6]-]- 3 marks

- Ensures **right person–job fit**, increasing satisfaction.
- Reduces **mismatch and job dissatisfaction**.
- Improves **commitment and retention** of employees.

13. Discuss the relevance of people-oriented culture in modern organisations. -[K] / [CO1)]- 3 marks

- Enhances **employee satisfaction and well-being**.
- Promotes **teamwork and collaboration**.
- Increases **productivity and organisational performance**.

14. Apply Resourcing strategies in selecting employees. - [A] / [CO2]-]- 3

marks

- Use of **job analysis and clear job descriptions**.
- Adoption of **structured recruitment and selection methods**.
- Focus on **competency-based hiring**.

15. Classify different types of employee benefits. -[An] / [CO3]]- 3 marks

- **Direct benefits** – salary, wages, bonuses.
- **Indirect benefits** – insurance, pension, leave.
- **Non-monetary benefits** – recognition, flexible work, job satisfaction.

16. Explain the relationship between power and leadership .- [K] / [CO4)]- 3 marks

- Power is the **ability to influence others**.
- Leadership uses power to **guide and motivate employees**.
- Effective leaders use **legitimate and referent power positively**.

17. Describe the features of a problem-solving organization - [K] / [CO5(]- 3 marks

- Encourages **innovation and critical thinking**.
- Promotes **teamwork and participation**.
- Uses **systematic decision-making processes**.

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Part C Short Essay Answer any 3 questions Each question carries 5 marks

18. Analyse how organisational culture affects organisational change and development. -[An] / [CO6]]- 5 marks

Supportive culture encourages acceptance of change and innovation.
Rigid culture resists change, slowing development.
Shared values influence **employee attitudes toward new policies**.
Culture shapes **communication and participation** during change.
Strong culture ensures **smooth implementation and sustainability** of change.

19. Analyse the concept and nature of Human Resource Development. -[An] / [CO1] - 5 marks

- HRD is a **continuous process** of developing employee skills and competencies.
- Focuses on **training, learning, and career development**.
- Aims at **improving individual and organisational performance**.
- It is **future-oriented**, preparing employees for higher roles.
- Integrates **personal growth with organisational goals**.

20. Assess the importance of HR strategy in achieving goals. -[E] / [CO2] - 5 marks

Aligns **human resources with organisational objectives**.
Ensures **effective utilization of workforce**.
Helps in **long-term planning and sustainability**.
Improves **competitive advantage through talent management**.
Facilitates **adaptation to changes in the environment**.

21. Illustrate how HRP improves employee performance. -[A] / [CO 3] - 5 marks

- Ensures **right number of employees with right skills**.
- Identifies **training and development needs**.
- Reduces **workload imbalance and stress**.
- Enhances **job satisfaction and motivation**.
- Promotes **efficient deployment of human resources**.

22. Examine the strategic importance of HRM. -[An] / [CO4] - 5 marks

- Contributes to **achievement of organisational goals**.
- Builds **competitive advantage through skilled workforce**.
- Enhances **employee productivity and efficiency**.
- Supports **change management and innovation**.
- Ensures **employee engagement and retention**.

Part D Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks

23. Evaluate the effectiveness of on-the-job and off-the-job training methods-[**Effectiveness of On-the-Job Training** a) **Learning by doing** improves practical skills quickly. b) Provides **real work experience** in actual job conditions. c) Cost-effective as no separate training infrastructure is needed. d) Immediate **application of knowledge** enhances retention. e) Builds **confidence and job familiarity**. f) Encourages **interaction with supervisors and peers**. g) Limitation: May lead to **errors or reduced productivity** during training. h) Limitation: Quality depends on the **trainer's ability**. **Effectiveness of Off-the-Job Training** a) Provides a **structured and systematic learning environment**. b) Allows focus without **workplace distractions**. c) Useful for **theoretical knowledge and conceptual understanding**. d) Exposure to **new ideas, techniques, and innovations**. e) Safer learning environment—**no risk to actual operations**. f) Limitation: **Higher cost** and requires special facilities. g) Limitation: Less opportunity for **immediate practical application**.	**An] / [CO5]** 8 marks 7 marks
24. Discuss how learning and development contribute to organizational effectiveness.- **Contribution of Learning and Development to Organizational Effectiveness** a) **Enhances employee skills and competencies-** Improves job performance and efficiency. b) **Increases productivity-** Well-trained employees perform tasks faster and more accurately. c) **Supports achievement of organizational goals-** Aligns employee capabilities with business objectives. d) **Promotes innovation and creativity-** Encourages new ideas and problem-solving abilities. e) **Improves employee morale and motivation-** Learning opportunities increase job satisfaction. f) **Facilitates adaptation to change-** Helps employees cope with technological and organizational changes. g) **Strengthens leadership development-** Prepares future leaders and managers. h) **Reduces employee turnover-** Career development opportunities enhance retention. i) **Improves quality of work and services-** Leads to better customer satisfaction. j) **Encourages continuous improvement culture-** Builds a learning-oriented organization. k) **Enhances teamwork and collaboration-** Develops communication and interpersonal skills. l) **Bridges skill gaps-** Identifies and addresses deficiencies in workforce capabilities. m) **Supports succession planning-** Ensures availability of skilled personnel for key roles. n) **Boosts organizational competitiveness-** Skilled workforce provides a competitive advantage. o) **Ensures long-term growth and sustainability-** Continuous learning supports organizational development.	**[An] / [CO6]** 15 marks
25. Discuss the various dimensions of HRP with suitable examples. [An] / [CO1] **Dimensions of HRP** 1. **Quantitative Dimension (Manpower Planning)-** Focuses on the **number of employees required**. *Example:* Estimating the need for 50 workers in a new factory. 2. **Qualitative Dimension (Skill Planning)-** Emphasizes **skills, knowledge, and competencies** needed. *Example:* Hiring IT professionals with specific programming skills. 3. **Time Dimension-** Deals with **short-term and long-term workforce planning**. *Example:* Immediate hiring vs. future leadership development. 4. **Demand Forecasting-** Predicts future **HR requirements** based on organizational growth. *Example:* Expansion plans increasing staff needs. 5. **Supply Forecasting-** Assesses **availability of internal and external workforce**. *Example:* Promotions vs. hiring new employees. 6. **Utilization Dimension-** Ensures **effective use of existing employees**. *Example:* Job rotation to maximize productivity. 7. **Development Dimension-** Focuses on **training and development of employees**. *Example:* Skill enhancement programs for employees.	. [An] / [CO1] 15 marks

8. **Career Planning Dimension-** Supports **employee growth and career progression**. *Example:* Promotion pathways within the organization. 9. **Retention Dimension-** Aims to **retain skilled employees**. *Example:* Providing incentives and benefits. 10. **Cost Dimension-** Considers **budget and cost-effectiveness** of HR activities. *Example:* Balancing hiring costs with organizational budget. 11. **Flexibility Dimension-** Adapts to **changing business needs and environment**. *Example:* Hiring contractual or part-time staff. 12. **Strategic Dimension-** Aligns HRP with **organizational goals and strategies**. *Example:* Recruiting talent to support digital transformation. 13. **Technological Dimension-** Considers impact of **technology on workforce needs**. *Example:* Automation reducing manual labor demand. 14. **Global Dimension-** Addresses **international workforce planning**. *Example:* Hiring employees for overseas operations. 15. **Diversity Dimension-** Promotes **inclusive workforce planning**. *Example:* Hiring from diverse backgrounds to improve innovation.	
26. Analyze the various theories of employee motivation. -[An] / [CO2] **<u>Content Theories of Motivation (Focus on Needs)</u>** **1. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs – Abraham Maslow-** Human needs are arranged in five levels: physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization. **a) Relevance-** Helps managers understand employee needs at different levels. **b) Limitation-** Needs may not always follow a strict hierarchy. **2. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory – Frederick Herzberg** Differentiates between hygiene factors (salary, conditions) and motivators (achievement, recognition). **a) Analysis-** Satisfaction and dissatisfaction arise from different factors. **b)Limitation-** Over-simplifies motivation and ignores individual differences. **3.McClelland's Needs Theory – David McClelland** Focuses on need for achievement, power, and affiliation. **a) Application-** Useful in identifying managerial and leadership potential. **<u>Process Theories of Motivation (Focus on Behaviour)</u>** **1. Expectancy Theory – Victor Vroom** Motivation depends on expectation of reward and its value. **a) Analysis-** Employees are motivated when effort leads to performance and rewards. **2. Equity Theory – John Stacey Adams** Employees compare their input-output ratio with others. **a) Implication-** Perceived fairness affects motivation and satisfaction. **3. Goal-Setting Theory – Edwin Locke** Specific and challenging goals improve performance. **a) Analysis-** Feedback and clarity enhance motivation. **Overall Analysis** Different theories highlight that motivation is influenced by **needs, perceptions, fairness, and goals**, and no single theory fully explains employee motivation.	. -[An] / [CO2] 7 marks 7 marks 1 mark